

Interview Transcript — Candidate A (Rohan Malhotra)

Technical Section

Q1 (Interviewer): Walk me through the exception-handling engine you built at Voltrix.

A1: It's planner-executor-reviewer. Failures come in, get classified, retried or escalated, then double-checked. I designed the whole retry/escalation logic.

Q2: What made you choose that structure over a simpler rule-based system?

A2: Rules don't scale. Too many failure types — timeouts, bad EDI, missing BOL fields. Agents handle that better.

Q3: How do you measure whether the reviewer agent is actually catching real problems?

A3: We track override rate. It's low. I'd have to check the exact number though, haven't looked recently.

Q4: What's your approach to model routing?

A4: Cost-based. Simple stuff to the SLM, harder reasoning to GPT-4. No formal study, just tuned it as things broke.

Behavioral Section

Q5 (Interviewer): Tell me about a time you disagreed with a teammate on a technical decision.

A5: Teammate wanted to hardcode more categories up front. I pushed for the agent approach. We went with mine.

Q6: Who actually wrote the retry/escalation logic that's in production now?

A6: I designed it. Priya did a lot of the implementation, I reviewed her PRs. I was the architect.

Q7 (Skeptic follow-up): Your resume says "sole architect." But it sounds like Priya built a lot of it. Can you clarify?

A7: Fine — "sole architect" is probably too strong. I led the design, she built most of the production version.

Ownership / Hiring Manager Section

Q8: Why should we invest in ramping you up here versus someone with more freight-domain experience?

A8: I move fast. I've built something structurally close to this already. I don't think I'd need much ramp time.

Q9: This role needs long-term ownership of production reliability. How do you feel about being on-call for agent failures?

A9: Fine, I've done on-call before. Though Voltrix's user base is still small, so I haven't seen serious incident volume yet.

Q10: You've had three roles in 3.5 years, each under a year except the first. What's driving that?

A10: Better pay and title, mostly. Voltrix is more aligned with what I want long-term.